Adam Hickey

Senior Digital Designer · Brand Identity · Visual Systems · Interactive and Interface Design · Front-End Prototyping

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Professional summary

Senior digital designer with 20 years of brand-led sites, identities, illustration and interfaces, for organizations including Cargill, Intel, CBRE, Toro, Lund Boats and Fulton Beer. I began as a graphic designer and front-end developer at three Minneapolis studios, making visually rich sites, campaigns and apps; spent thirteen years bringing visual coherence, hierarchy and a shared design language to large enterprise products and design systems; and now design and build independent products and brand work end to end. I bring visual judgment, typographic craft and the technical fluency (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, prototyping, AI-assisted development) to carry an idea through to a finished digital experience.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Brand, digital and interactive design — 2026 – Present

- **Say When** — A self-initiated, fictional coffee brand made to show the whole arc: strategy, naming, logo and identity, three-product packaging system, a campaign, and a working storefront prototype with a plain-language coffee finder, all designed and built in HTML, CSS, SVG and JavaScript.
- **Door County Found** and **Lucy Learns** — Two products in use, designed, illustrated and built end to end: an editorial travel brand and guide (identity, art direction, voice, site), and an illustrated dog-training app readable one-handed from across a room.
- **Faunaform** (in progress) and **While We're Here** — Art direction and production tooling for a screen-print studio; a 300mm square hardcover of essays, designed and produced from HTML and CSS to press-ready files.
- **Agent Review** and **Dispatch Cockpit** — Interactive prototypes exploring AI-assisted work, built with coding agents.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer — 2013 – 2026

- Led UX and visual design for large enterprise digital experiences, application suites and operational software for clients in logistics, manufacturing, healthcare, financial services and the public sector: hierarchy, layout and polish that made complicated interfaces feel coherent and finished.
- Led the Innovators Studio identity and ecosystem for a global corporation's internal innovation network: identity, illustration and badges, presentation and newsletter systems, campaigns, and a community portal, over four fiscal years.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints; designed and built Connect, the firm's brand foundation and design-system site. Led accessibility, DesignOps and governance practices.
- Tied design decisions to the numbers product, engineering and business teams track, and used AI tools to scale documentation and audits with human judgment on every decision.

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer — Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

Designed and built brand-led websites, campaigns and apps for Lund Boats, Fulton Beer, Hazelden, Learn to Live (identity, character illustration and site) and others: two native iOS apps, an iPad app, Lund's boat configurator and Fulton's store locator, in HTML, CSS and jQuery across Joomla! and WordPress. Led rebrands and visual identity systems.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer — Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and built websites and interactive pieces in HTML, CSS and Flash with project managers, creative leads, writers and developers.

ByDesign — Design Intern — 2004 – 2006

Selected projects

- Innovators Studio: a reusable identity, illustration and template library that roughly halved the marketing team's campaign production time (a small sample of timesheets; a direction rather than a precise figure).
- 40+ SAP applications on one design system and accessibility standard: about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- A USDA grant-management portal that took data-analysis requests from 45–55 hours to just over 10, and a dispatch cockpit for a 450+ truck fleet whose board-clearing time fell roughly 30% per cycle.

Core capabilities

Visual Design · Brand Identity · Art Direction · Typography & Layout · Illustration · Interface & Interaction Design · Digital Campaigns · Design Systems · Accessibility · Prototyping in Code · Motion · AI-Assisted Production

Tools & platforms

Design: Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · SVG and CSS illustration · Image models for illustration pipelines · CSS custom properties (tokens) · WCAG 2.1 AA

Front end, by hand (2005–2013) and now: HTML · CSS · JavaScript/jQuery · Flash · WordPress · Joomla!

Build with coding agents: React · TypeScript · Storybook · Playwright · Git/GitHub · Claude Code · SAP Fiori, Sitecore, Umbraco platforms

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)